



Iranian Mathematical Society

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Subject: Formal Protest Against the Exclusion of Iranian Scholars from the 2026 International Congress of Mathematicians and a Call to Uphold IMU Resolution 7

Dear Prof. Hiraku Nakajima,

I am writing to you on behalf of the mathematical community in Iran to express our profound dismay and formal protest regarding a deeply concerning issue. It has come to our attention that the official registration website for the upcoming 2026 International Congress of Mathematicians (ICM), hosted under the auspices of our esteemed Union, is systematically blocking individuals attempting to connect from Iranian IP addresses. These individuals are met with a notification stating that they are subject to sanctions, effectively barring them from the registration process.

This action constitutes a de facto exclusion of Iranian mathematicians from one of the most significant gatherings in our field and stands in direct contradiction to the **very principles the IMU has vowed to protect**.

We draw your attention to **IMU Resolution 7**, which our Union has solemnly adopted. This resolution explicitly states:

"Notwithstanding these times of heightened tension and security concerns, we urge a continuation of scientific exchange and publication. The IMU opposes efforts either by governments, organizations, or individuals to restrict contacts and interactions in the world mathematical community. Specifically we oppose holding individual mathematicians liable for the actions of their governments." *

Furthermore, the resolution endorses the principle of the universality of science as defined by ICSU, which guarantees freedom of movement and communication in international scientific activities **"without any discrimination on the basis of such factors as citizenship, religion, creed, political stance, [or] ethnic origin."** It also mandates that the IMU **"shall not permit any of its activities to be disturbed by statements or actions of a political nature."**



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The current blockade, enforced by the local organizer, is a clear violation of this resolution. It is a textbook example of holding individual mathematicians liable for the actions of their government and allowing a political sanction to disrupt a core activity of our Union.

We respectfully but firmly request a clarification: How can the Union expect Iran to strive with great difficulty to meet its financial membership obligations while simultaneously being denied the core benefits of that membership, in direct opposition to its own statutes? This contradictory and unjust position undermines the very foundation of our collective scientific endeavor.

The consequences of this exclusion are severe. It not only stifles the academic growth of Iranian mathematicians but also impoverishes the entire global community by silencing valuable voices and hindering potential collaborations. Mathematics transcends borders and politics; it is a universal language meant to be shared for the betterment of all humanity.

We therefore urgently implore the International Mathematical Union, in its capacity as the patron of the ICM and the guardian of its own principles, to:

1. **Intervene directly** with the local organizing committee in the United States to find an immediate solution that allows Iranian mathematicians to register and participate fully in the 2026 Congress, thereby ensuring compliance with **Resolution 7**.
2. **Publicly reaffirm** its commitment to **Resolution 7** and the principles of inclusivity and non-discrimination, ensuring that future conferences are not platforms for the enforcement of national political sanctions.
3. **Clarify its official policy** and establish clear mechanisms to guarantee the participation of scholars from all member states, irrespective of the political relations of their governments, as mandated by your own statutes.

The credibility of the IMU and the spirit of global mathematics hang in the balance. We trust in the Union's wisdom and its foundational commitment to the global mathematical community, as so clearly articulated in its own resolutions. We look forward to your prompt and decisive action to resolve this unacceptable situation.

Respectfully yours,
O.A.S. Karamzadeh *O. A. S. KARAMZADEH*
IMS President